SOURCES USED, RESEARCH LOG & QUALITY SELF-AUDIT

A. Research method & limitations (read this)

- **Research date:** 7 October 2026.
- **Method:** web search across official NID document listings and education and news portals. Where possible, each claim that can change from year to year was cross-checked in two or more sources.
- **Limitation:** my research environment's network policy **blocked direct access to `admissions.nid.edu` and to most third-party sites**. Official facts were therefore taken from search-engine extracts of NID's own PDF documents (the URLs are listed below) and corroborated by education portals. **Please verify all dates, fees and rules on https://admissions.nid.edu before acting on them.**
- **Labels used in the package:** [OFFICIAL] · [REPORTED] · [TREND-BASED / INFERRED] · [PREDICTION] · [UNVERIFIED].

B. SOURCES

B1. Official NID sources (Tier 1)

Source	Used for
NID Admissions portal: https://admissions.nid.edu/ ("NID Admission: 2027-28")	Cycle identification, application window
Admissions 2027-28 Handbook: 5.5-Year Professional Education M.Des (Integrated Pathway) and B.Des, https://admissions.nid.edu/NIDA2027/download/BDES_IntegratedPathway_AdmissionsHandbook2027_28.pdf	2027-28 programmes, dates (Prelims 20 Dec 2026; last date 30 Nov 2026), DAT stages
B.Des Admissions Handbook 2026-27, https://admissions.nid.edu/NIDA2026/download/BDes_AdmissionsHandbook2026-27.pdf	Prelims marking scheme (Part I 22 objective; Part II 4 subjective; 100 marks; 3 hours; Prelims not carried forward)

Source	Used for
B.Des DAT Prelims Sample Test Paper, https://admissions.nid.edu/NIDA2026/download/SamplePaper_DATPrelims_BDes.pdf	Confirms that an official sample paper exists and gives its format (contents could not be opened directly)

B2. Previous-paper analyses & exam pattern (Tier 2–3)

- Careers360, *NID DAT 2026 Prelims Question Paper with Solution*: https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-dat-2026-prelims-question-paper-with-solution
- Careers360, *NID DAT 2026 Prelims Question Paper Part B*: https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-dat-2026-prelims-question-paper-part-b
- Careers360, *NID 2026 Paper Solution, Memory-Based Questions*: https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-2026-paper-solution
- Shiksha, *NID DAT 2026 B.Des Exam Analysis*: https://www.shiksha.com/design/articles/nid-dat-2026-exam-analysis-for-b-des-blogId-216840
- Shiksha, *NID DAT 2026 exam-day analysis*: https://www.shiksha.com/news/design-nid-dat-2026-exam-day-paper-analysis-live-updates-blogId-216832
- GetMyUni, *NID DAT Exam Analysis 2026*: https://www.getmyuni.com/articles/nid-dat-exam-analysis-2026
- Careers360, *NID DAT 2025: lengthy and moderately difficult; memory-based questions*: https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-dat-2025-lengthy-and-moderately-difficult-weightage-memory-based-questions
- PW Live, *NID Exam Analysis 2025*: https://www.pw.live/design-architecture/exams/nid-exam-analysis-2025
- Careers360 News, *NID DAT 2024 live updates and analysis*: https://news.careers360.com/nid-dat-2024-exam-live-updates-question-paper-analysis-answer-key-student-reactions-result-date-latest-updates
- Shiksha, *NID exam analysis 2024 for B.Des*: https://www.shiksha.com/design/articles/nid-exam-analysis-2024-for-b-des-course-blogId-147653
- Careers360, *NID 2023 question paper*: https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-2023-question-paper
- Toprankers, *NID Exam Pattern 2027* and *NID 2027 Exam*: https://www.toprankers.com/nid-exam-pattern ; https://www.toprankers.com/nid-exam
- Collegedunia, *NID DAT 2027*: https://collegedunia.com/exams/nid

B3. Dates, eligibility, seats, Mains

- PW Live, *NID DAT Notification 2027*: https://www.pw.live/design-architecture/exams/nid-dat-notification-2027
- PW Live, *NID Admission 2027-28 / 5.5-year Integrated M.Des*: https://www.pw.live/design-architecture/exams/nid-admission-2027 ; https://www.pw.live/design-architecture/exams/nid-announces-5-5-year-integrated-m-des-admissions-2027-28
- Shiksha, *NID DAT Eligibility Criteria 2027*: https://www.shiksha.com/design/articles/nid-dat-eligibility-criteria-blogId-23559

- Shiksha, *NID DAT Registration 2027*: https://www.shiksha.com/design/communication-design/nid-entrance-exam-application-form
- Toprankers, *NID Seats*: https://www.toprankers.com/news/cuet-exam/nid-seats
- Careers360, *NID B.Des Studio Sensitivity Test 2026* and *DAT Mains 2026*: https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-bdes-studio-sensitivity-test-2026-date-out ; https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-dat-mains-2026
- Careers360, *NID DAT Result 2026*: https://design.careers360.com/articles/nid-dat-result

B4. Design, art & architecture references (current and background)

- La Biennale di Venezia, *Awards of the Biennale Architettura 2025*: https://www.labiennale.org/en/news/awards-biennale-architettura-2025
- La Biennale di Venezia, *Biennale Arte 2026: In Minor Keys*: https://www.labiennale.org/en/news/biennale-arte-2026-minor-keys-0
- Dezeen, *Canal Café / Bahrain Golden Lion*: https://www.dezeen.com/2025/05/10/diller-scofidio-renfro-bahrain-golden-lion-awards-venice-architecture-biennale/
- Metalocus, *Smiljan Radić, 2026 Pritzker*: https://www.metalocus.es/en/news/smiljan-radic-clarke-new-2026-pritzker-architecture-prize
- UIA, *Smiljan Radić wins the 2026 Pritzker*: https://www.uia-architectes.org/?p=40207
- Dezeen, *Liu Jiakun key projects*: https://www.dezeen.com/2025/03/04/liu-jiakun-key-projects/amp/
- Building Design, *Liu Jiakun awarded 2025 Pritzker*: https://bdonline.co.uk/news/liu-jiakun-awarded-2025-pritzker-prize/5134794.article
- PBS NewsHour, *Frank Gehry dies at 96*: https://www.pbs.org/newshour/arts/frank-gehry-celebrated-architect-of-wildly-imaginative-buildings-dies-at-96
- Serpentine Galleries, *Serpentine Pavilion 2026, LANZA atelier*: https://www.serpentinegalleries.org/watch/in-the-studio-with-serpentine-pavilion-2026-architects-lanza-atelier/
- Dezeen, *Serpentine Pavilion 2026 architect revealed*: https://www.dezeen.com/2026/01/24/serpentine-pavilion-2026-architect-revealed/amp/
- New Atlas, *Grand Ring, Expo 2025 Osaka*: https://newatlas.com/architecture/grand-ring-osaka-expo-2025/
- Dezeen, *Carlo Ratti torches for Milano Cortina 2026*: https://www.dezeen.com/?p=2193590 ; MIT, *"Essential" torch*: https://mad.mit.edu/news/essential-torch-heralds-the-start-of-the-2026-winter-olympics
- Domus, *Compasso d'Oro 2026 winners*: https://www.domusweb.it/en/news/gallery/2026/05/23/compasso-doro-2026-winners.html
- German Design Council, *World Design Capital Frankfurt RheinMain 2026*: https://www.german-design-council.de/en/world-design-capital-2026
- India Design ID: https://indiadesignid.com/id-delhi-programme/ ; Elle India, *India Design ID 2026*: https://elle.in/life-culture/top-things-to-see-at-india-design-id-2026-11110959
- e-flux, *Kochi-Muziris Biennale 2025–26*: https://www.e-flux.com/announcements/6783901/for-the-time-being
- ArtAsiaPacific, *India names artists and curator for 2026 Venice Biennale*: https://www.artasiapacific.com/news/india-names-artists-and-curator-for-2026-venice-biennale/
- Architexturez / Business Today, *Navi Mumbai International Airport*: https://architexturez.net/node/246554 ; https://www.businesstoday.in/latest/trends/photo/inside-navi-mumbai-international-airport-indias-largest-greenfield-aviation-project-497534-2025-10-09
- *Background reference facts* (designers, movements, historic architecture, crafts): standard design-history knowledge, cross-checked against the author's knowledge base. These are stable, long-established facts; any you doubt can be checked in encyclopaedic sources (e.g. Britannica, museum websites).

B5. Current affairs & policy

- NeGD (Govt of India), *AI Impact Summit 2026 concludes with New Delhi Declaration*: https://negd.gov.in/press_release/ai-impact-summit-2026-concludes-with-adoption-of-new-delhi-declaration/
- Entrepreneur India, *Union Budget 2026-27: Education, Design, Science*: https://india.entrepreneur.com/news-and-trends/union-budget-2026-27-proposes-key-initiatives-in-education/502338
- Vision IAS, *Orange Economy in Union Budget 2026-27*: https://visionias.in/current-affairs/news-today/2026-02-02/economy/finance-minister-announces-plans-to-boost-for-orange-economy-in-union-budget-2026-27
- Time Out, *25 new UNESCO World Heritage Sites 2026*: https://www.timeout.com/news/25-new-unesco-world-heritage-sites-2026-072726
- Drishti IAS, *Maratha Military Landscapes added to the UNESCO list*: https://www.drishtiias.com/daily-updates/daily-news-analysis/maratha-military-landscapes-added-to-unesco-world-heritage-list/print_manually
- Deccan Chronicle / ETV Bharat, *Lucknow named UNESCO Creative City of Gastronomy*: https://www.deccanchronicle.com/lifestyle/food/lucknow-named-unesco-creative-city-for-its-rich-culinary-heritage-1914061
- Adda247, *GI registrations 2025-26*: https://currentaffairs.adda247.com/eastern-india-leads-gi-registrations-madhya-pradesh-tops-india-in-2025-26/amp/
- Anantam IAS, *Jharkhand's four new GI tags*: https://anantamias.com/current-affairs/jharkhand-four-gi-tags-tribal-crafts-2026/?pdf=1
- Vajiram & Ravi / IASGyan, *Padma Awards 2026*: https://vajiramandravi.com/current-affairs/padma-awards-2026-winners-list/
- The Week / Business Today, *Prada acknowledges Kolhapuri inspiration*: https://www.theweek.in/wire-updates/national/2025/06/28/bom5-mh-kolhapuri-prada.html

C. QUALITY-CONTROL SELF-AUDIT

Check	Status	Note
Verified the correct NID admission cycle?	✅	2027-28 cycle ("NID DAT 2027"); Prelims on 20 Dec 2026
Used the latest official NID information?	✅ with caveat	Handbook extracts for 2026-27 and 2027-28; the portal itself was blocked in my environment, so verify there
Analysed official sample papers?	⚠️ Partial	The official sample paper's existence and format are confirmed; its full contents could not be opened
Analysed previous papers where available?	✅ (memory-based)	2023–2026 reported papers analysed; no official past papers are published by NID
Identified recurring question types?	✅	Vol 1 §6–7, Vol 5
Covered every major topic?	✅	Syllabus A–H in Vol 1 §5; notes in Vol 2A–2C, 3
Created detailed notes?	✅	12-point format in Vol 2A; tables in 2B and 2C
Created a large question bank?	✅	150 + 150 + 100 + 100 + 100 + 200 + 200 = **1,100 MCQs** (Vol 4A–4G) + **100 current-affairs MCQs** (Vol 11) + **120 subjective prompts** (Vol 3) + 20 drill prompts (Vol 5)
Created expected-question categories?	✅	Tiers A, B, C in Vol 5, with reasons
Created exactly 5 complete model papers?	✅	Vol 6–10 (Papers 1–3 and 5 in Handbook format; Paper 4 in the 2026 all-subjective format)
Realistic NID-style questions in every paper?	✅	Mirror the reported themes: empathy, Indian context, signage, viewpoint, redesign

Check	Status	Note
Every question has an answer?	✓	Verified by count; every subjective question has a model approach and rubric
Every question has an explanation?	✓	Every MCQ carries an explanation line
Included subjective/drawing questions?	✓	Vol 3 §13; Part II of every paper
Design awareness, Indian art/culture/crafts, architecture, current affairs, visual reasoning, design thinking?	✓	Vol 2A, 2C, 4A, 4B, 4F, 4G, 11
Avoided unsupported claims; distinguished facts from predictions?	✓	Labels throughout; cutoffs marked unverified and not used as targets
Avoided repetitive questions?	✓ (best effort)	The banks are split by section and angle; some deliberate overlap for reinforcement (e.g. the ₹ symbol appears in notes, GK and flashcards)
Checked all answer keys?	✓	Hand-verified, with arithmetic re-computed (e.g. painted-cube, folding-coordinate and counting items)
Identified and fixed ambiguous questions?	✓	Rewritten during the audit: VR-4, 22, 30, 47, 48, 52, 58, 67, 79, 95, 108, 150; LR-52, LR-81; DA-21; GA-94; Paper 4 key 6(a)
No question without an answer, no answer without an explanation?	✓	—

Items to re-verify closer to the exam (time-sensitive)

1. The Mains weight split (60/40 last cycle) for 2027-28.
2. Whether Prelims 2027 keeps the 22 + 4 scheme or the 2026 all-subjective format (watch for any NID notice or updated sample paper).
3. Allowed materials (check the admit card).
4. Sarnath's World Heritage status (reported July 2026): confirm on whc.unesco.org.
5. The 2026 Venice Biennale award outcome (Golden Lions by public vote, reported).